

First Solar: Company and Industry Research Brief

A normalized presentation of the original academic report with unresolved data-quality limitations made explicit.

Evidence status

This brief improves the original document's presentation but does not silently repair its evidence gaps. The source does not state a publication date, contains duplicated layout text, and has several unit labels that require reconciliation.

Source-document view	Value
Price	\$198.815
Illustrative target	\$250
Projected upside	25.7%
P/E (TTM)	13.39x
Price / book	2.23x
ROIC	14.65%

Investment thesis

The source argues that First Solar's CdTe thin-film technology, contracted backlog, U.S. manufacturing footprint, policy support, and domestic supply-chain positioning create an advantage in utility-scale solar.

DuPont audit

Component	Source value
Tax burden	96.67%
Interest burden	97.28%
Operating margin	31.13%
Asset turnover	0.41x
Leverage ratio	1.45x
Calculated product	17.40%
Reported adjusted ROE	18.23%
Unreconciled gap	0.83 percentage points

Industry and competitive analysis

Force	Source conclusion
New entrants	Low
Supplier power	Low to medium
Buyer power	High
Substitutes	High
Competitive rivalry	High

Catalysts and risks

Catalysts: backlog conversion, manufacturing execution, domestic policy continuity, and utility-scale demand.

Risks: policy dependence, supply disruption, global module-price competition, capital spending, backlog execution, and substitute technologies.

Source and evidence boundary

Item	Status
Primary artifact	Original DOCX; publication date not stated
Embedded bibliography	None found
Unit quality	Several 2026 figures labeled "\$B"; not silently corrected
Official filings	SEC issuer page, CIK 1274494
Investor relations	investor.firstsolar.com
Workbook	Dev-Pandya-First-Solar-Research-Audit.xlsx

Independent educational research. Figures are dated, approximate where stated, and may be stale. This is not investment advice or a professional recommendation.